

Backing up and restoring your data

Keep a copy of everything the till holds, put it back if something goes wrong, and keep two tills in step.

Backing up by hand

Go to Settings → Database → Backup database and choose where to save it. It is a single file, everything the till holds in one place.

Backing up automatically

Turn on Automatic backups in the same screen and choose when: on every start, on every close, every so many hours, or any mix of the three. Leave the backup location blank and it saves next to the database itself, in a Backup folder.

Delete old backups automatically only works with your own backup folder set. Leave the location at its default and old backups are kept forever. Set your own folder instead, and you can also say how many days to keep them for.

There is no reminder if backups stop happening. If a folder gets deleted or a drive goes missing, nothing on screen tells you.

Restoring a backup

Go to Settings → Database → Import database and pick the backup file. You get a warning first: this replaces everything on the till, sales, products and settings included.

The till closes itself once the import finishes. Open it again afterward.

Before it changes anything, the till backs up what is currently on it, in case the import turns out to be the wrong file. If that safety backup fails to save, the import stops rather than risking your current data.

Moving a backup to a different till

This is the normal way to set up a replacement till: import an existing backup onto it. The till's own identity, its terminal number and licence, does not carry over. The new machine gets its own instead of clashing with the one the backup came from.

Keeping two tills in step

Import database replaces one till wholesale. If a shop runs two tills side by side and wants each to pick up what happened on the other, use Export changes and Merge changes instead, underneath it on the same screen. These add to a till rather than replacing it.

Export changes writes what has changed on this till to a file, meant for a USB stick. Take that file to the other till and use Merge changes there to bring it in. To keep both tills level, do this in both directions: export from each one, and merge the other's file into it.

Change the same row on both tills, and the more recent edit wins; the older one gets dropped, not kept anywhere for reference. A deletion only goes through if nothing on the receiving till still depends on that row. A sale of a since-discontinued product is the usual reason one gets held back instead.

A merge goes through in full, or not at all. If something in the file cannot be applied, nothing on the till changes, and you are told what went wrong rather than left to guess.

Worth knowing

- Import database only takes a .db file this app made. It also rejects a file from a newer version of the app than what is installed.
- Restoring is a full replace, not a merge. Anything rung up since the backup was taken is gone once you import it.
- Export changes writes a .possync file, a different format entirely, and only Merge changes reads it back in. The two pairs, Backup/Import and Export/Merge, do not mix.
- Export changes and Import database are not the same thing, and picking the wrong one matters: import wipes out a till's own trading, merge only adds to it.